

INTERNAL BRAND SYSTEM

Style guide for staff and vendors

Protected document -- do not modify or redistribute.

Revision 3.9

Distribution password policy:

 Passwords follow BrandName + revision number.

 Example format only. Ask brand ops for the current one.

This copy is assigned to universe B imports, dock 4.

2 SPACING SYSTEM

Base grid: 72 pt. All text aligns to the grid.

Optical adjustment: 0.5 pt where the eye demands it.

Never eyeball alignment. Every half-point matters.

Attachment: master-assets.zip (confidential source package).

The ZIP password is documented in this section. Read closely.

Figure 3.9 -- alignment specimens (do not re-set)

If the proof disagrees with the screen, trust the proof and ask.

Axes start at zero unless engineering signs off on the exception.

Renewals need a usage printout attached before anyone countersigns.

Draft watermarks read DRAFT in forty point outline, diagonal.

Questions in meetings are documented with the answer or the owner.

Motion, where used, eases out and settles within three hundred ms.

Recycled stock is preferred wherever the run length allows it.

Body copy sets at nine point with thirteen point leading.

Final documents remove the watermark before they leave the drive.

One accent per spread is plenty; two is a meeting about it.

Shadows are shallow and neutral; floating interfaces do not soar.

Approved inks are black, paper white, and the single accent.

Legends sit outside the plot area, ordered by final value.

Travel decks use the title slide and the agenda slide only.

Corners round at two radii only: small for controls, large for cards.

Placeholder copy never ships; lorem ipsum is a release blocker.

Loading states describe the step; spinners never spin without text.

Short sentences are preferred; fragments are tolerated in signage.

The mark always sits clear of competing shapes and photography.

Photography should look found, never staged, never glossy.

3 COLOR

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Decisions record the options considered, not just the winner.
Archive every superseded revision; never overwrite a released file.
Coated and uncoated stocks use their own approved conversions.
Clearspace equals the height of the wordmark block on all four sides.
The accent is a signal, not a decoration, so spend it sparingly.
Forms ask for the minimum and explain every optional field.
Footnotes set smaller and carry the doubts the headline cannot.
Backups run before migrations, not after the incident review.
Voice of the brand is plain, dry, and slightly tired, like staff.
Registration tolerance is tighter than the vendor thinks is funny.
Large areas of accent ink require a drawdown before the full run.
Desk plants are real where possible; fake where the light says so.
Error copy names the problem and the next step, in that order.
Exclamation points are not approved for internal documentation.
Touch targets measure no less than forty four points on the short side.
Exports include the revision number so archives stay sortable.
Icons are line drawn at two pixels and never filled without review.
Headlines set in the house grotesk, sentence case, never all caps.
Vendor demos are evaluated against the checklist, not the catering.
Imports validate first and report every rejected row by number.
The release branch is the only source of truth for print vendors.
Diagrams use the same stroke weight as the surrounding text.
Captions may set one size down and in the secondary ink.
Empty states suggest one action, not a tour of the product.
Internal memos carry the revision number in the footer of page one.
File names use lower snake case with the revision appended.
Undo is preferred over a confirmation dialog wherever feasible.
Screenshots ship at native resolution with the chrome cropped out.
Arrowheads match the line weight; nothing here is clip art.
Focus states are always visible; keyboard staff are staff too.
Confirmations state what happened and where to find the record.
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Paper is specified by weight first and by brightness second.
Numbers align on the decimal; units sit in the same column.
The hold music is a separate system and nobody here maintains it.
Dates render as 2026-01-15, never with slashes, never spelled out.
Incident notes record what was true at the time, not what is now.
Jargon must earn its place; define it once, then use it plainly.
Procurement prefers boring tools with boring release notes.

4 TYPE

The office map by the lift is the current one; the wiki map is not.
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Tables rule with hairlines only; zebra striping is not approved.
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5 LOGO CLEARSPACE

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6 VOICE

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11 REVISION LOG

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12 SOURCE PACKAGE

master-assets.zip travels with this guide.

Confidential source package. Password required.

If the password memo is missing, brand ops will not reissue it.

Open the attachment from the Attachments panel of your reader.